

INTRO

Suppose someone just gives you the plaintext of K4. After all the commotion of the reveal and maybe the disappointment is gone what would be your first question?

Mine would be: How?

The decryption or decipherment of K4 isn't about being the first, but about the beauty of how it is done. This is also the reason why so far i never cooperated with someone because it distracts me from forming my own ideas, observations and sometimes it even prevents me from making some progress.

In the steps i will present to you not all reasons why something is done will be given, but there will be enough so that someone can make up their own mind. And that is what -in my humble opinion- it is all about.

Every step will follow on the discovery of the previous steps. I hope there is enough explanation for everybody to follow what's going on.

If not, let me know and i'll elaborate further as soon as possible.

This is not about me, but about you !

With all my steps presented to you i'm trying to set your brains into the mode needed to solve the final 97 characters of KRYPTOS.

Continue to do your own work, be skeptical, question, build your own theory...

Fact is that K4 can only be solved the way it is meant to be solved. There are no shortcuts and it is more than secure enough to withstand anything else.

Enjoy !

OBSERVATIONS

This is the plaintext of K1-K3, and all that is needed to solve the last part of Kryptos.

There will be a step that references to the cypher text, but it is just that, and that's for later on.

B	E	T	W	E	E	N	S	U	B	T	L	E	S	H	A	D	I	N	G	A	N	D	T	H	E	A	B	S	E	N	C
E	O	F	L	I	G	H	T	L	I	E	S	T	H	E	N	U	A	N	C	E	O	F	I	Q	L	U	S	I	O	N	
I	T	W	A	S	T	O	T	A	L	L	Y	I	N	V	I	S	I	B	L	E	H	O	W	S	T	H	A	T	P	O	
S	S	I	B	L	E	?	T	H	E	Y	U	S	E	D	T	H	E	E	A	R	T	H	S	M	A	G	N	E	T		
I	C	F	I	E	L	D	X	T	H	E	I	N	F	O	R	M	A	T	I	O	N	W	A	S	G	A	T	H	E	R	
E	D	A	N	D	T	R	A	N	S	M	I	T	T	E	D	U	N	D	E	R	G	R	U	U	N	D	T	O	A	N	U
N	K	N	O	W	N	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	X	D	O	E	S	L	A	N	G	L	E	Y	K	N	O	W	A	
B	O	U	T	T	H	I	S	?	T	H	E	Y	S	H	O	U	L	D	I	T	S	B	U	R	I	E	D	O	U	T	
T	H	E	R	E	S	O	M	E	W	H	E	R	E	X	W	H	O	K	N	O	W	S	T	H	E	E	X	A	C	T	L
O	C	A	T	I	O	N	?	O	N	L	Y	W	W	T	H	I	S	W	A	S	H	I	S	L	A	S	T	M	E	S	
S	A	G	E	X	T	H	I	R	T	Y	E	I	G	H	T	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	F	I	F	T	Y	S	E		
V	E	N	M	I	N	U	T	E	S	S	I	X	P	O	I	N	T	F	I	V	E	S	E	C	O	N	D	S	N	O	
R	T	H	S	E	V	E	N	T	Y	S	E	V	E	N	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	E	I	G	H	T	M	I	N	U	
T	E	S	F	O	R	T	Y	F	O	U	R	S	E	C	O	N	D	S	W	E	S	T	X	L	A	Y	E	R	T	W	O

S	L	O	W	L	Y	D	E	S	P	A	R	A	T	L	Y	S	L	O	W	L	Y	T	H	E	R	E	M	A	I	N	S	
O	F	P	A	S	S	A	G	E	D	E	B	R	I	S	T	H	A	T	E	N	C	U	M	B	E	R	E	D	T			
H	E	L	O	W	E	R	P	A	R	T	O	F	T	H	E	D	O	O	R	W	A	Y	W	A	S	R	E	M	O	V		
E	D	W	I	T	H	T	R	E	M	B	L	I	N	G	H	A	N	D	S	I	M	A	D	E	A	T	I	N	Y			
B	R	E	A	C	H	I	N	T	H	E	U	P	P	E	R	L	E	F	T	H	A	N	D	C	O	R	N	E	R	A	N	
D	T	H	E	N	W	I	D	E	N	I	N	G	T	H	E	H	O	L	E	A	L	I	T	T	L	E	I	I	N			
S	E	R	T	E	D	T	H	E	C	A	N	D	L	E	A	N	D	P	E	E	R	E	D	I	N	T	H	E	H	O	T	
A	I	R	E	S	C	A	P	I	N	G	F	R	O	M	T	H	E	C	H	A	M	B	E	R	C	A	U	S	E	D		
T	H	E	F	L	A	M	E	T	O	F	L	I	C	K	E	R	B	U	T	P	R	E	S	E	N	T	L	Y	D	E	T	A
I	L	S	O	F	T	H	E	R	O	O	M	W	I	T	H	I	N	E	M	E	R	G	E	D	F	R	O	M				
T	H	E	M	I	S	T	X	C	A	N	Y	O	U	S	E	E	A	N	Y	T	H	I	N	G	Q	?						

																			O	B	K	R								
U	O	X	O	G	H	U	L	B	S	O	L	I	F	B	B	W	F	L	R	V	Q	Q	P	R	N	G	K	S	S	O
T	W	T	Q	S	J	Q	S	S	E	K	Z	Z	W	A	T	J	K	L	U	D	I	A	W	I	N	F	B	N	Y	P
V	T	T	M	Z	F	P	K	W	G	D	K	Z	X	T	J	C	D	I	G	K	U	H	U	A	U	E	K	C	A	R

To make it easy i have split up K1-2, K3 and the last part, known as K4. K4 does not do it justice. It is much more than just a single puzzle. Hence the name of the files: “LP” for Last Part.

There's also the morse code pieces and the compass rose.

Mr Sanborn said it is pencil and paper, and in an artistic way...

Note how the line ends of the first two parts form something like the character “E” if you squint your eyes. (That is after correcting for “X Layer two”).

Also note that the last part (K4) has equal line ends, and is 31 characters long, with some trailing at the beginning of it. (OBKR)

STEP 1

Doing something to the final 97 is for step 5. So put them aside for now. There's quite a bit of work to be done before that, and it has taken me several years of getting stuck and starting over to discover that.

The first two parts are just text, without anything that can be used as an instruction. The third part is a simple instruction.

Put the first three parts into a matrix with the same number of columns as the last part. (31 wide) Let the remaining characters trail. Don't worry that it's not a perfect matrix.

Do not error correct DESPARATLY just yet. That's for later, in step 2.

As per instructions in K3, remove the remains; that is deleting the question marks. There's no need for them anymore.

After that create a gap in the upper left hand corner and insert a candle. The candle is the word KRYPTOS.

This is what you should have now.

	K	R	Y	P	T	O	S	B	E	T	W	E	E	N	S	U	B	T	L	E	S	H	A	D	I	N	G	A	N	D	T
	H	E	A	B	S	E	N	C	E	O	F	L	I	G	H	T	L	I	E	S	T	H	E	N	U	A	N	C	E	O	F
	I	Q	L	U	S	I	O	N	I	T	W	A	S	T	O	T	A	L	L	Y	I	N	V	I	S	I	B	L	E	H	O
	W	S	T	H	A	T	P	O	S	S	I	B	L	E	?	T	H	E	Y	U	S	E	D	T	H	E	E	A	R	T	H
	S	M	A	G	N	E	T	I	C	F	I	E	L	D	X	T	H	E	I	N	F	O	R	M	A	T	I	O	N	W	A
	S	G	A	T	H	E	R	E	D	A	N	D	T	R	A	N	S	M	I	T	T	E	D	U	N	D	E	R	G	R	U
	U	N	D	T	O	A	N	U	N	K	N	O	W	N	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	X	D	O	E	S	L	A	N	G
	L	E	Y	K	N	O	W	A	B	O	U	T	T	H	I	S	?	T	H	E	Y	S	H	O	U	L	D	I	T	S	B
	U	R	I	E	D	O	U	T	T	H	E	R	E	S	O	M	E	W	H	E	R	E	X	W	H	O	K	N	O	W	S
	T	H	E	E	X	A	C	T	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	?	O	N	L	Y	W	W	T	H	I	S	W	A	S	H
	I	S	L	A	S	T	M	E	S	S	A	G	E	X	T	H	I	R	T	Y	E	I	G	H	T	D	E	G	R	E	E
	S	F	I	F	T	Y	S	E	V	E	N	M	I	N	U	T	E	S	S	I	X	P	O	I	N	T	F	I	V	E	S
	E	C	O	N	D	S	N	O	R	T	H	S	E	V	E	N	T	Y	S	E	V	E	N	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	E
L	I	G	H	T	M	I	N	U	T	E	S	F	O	R	T	Y	F	O	U	R	S	E	C	O	N	D	S	W	E	S	T
	X	L	A	Y	E	R	T	W	O	S	L	O	W	L	Y	D	E	S	P	A	R	A	T	L	Y	S	L	O	W	L	Y
	T	H	E	R	E	M	A	I	N	S	O	F	P	A	S	S	A	G	E	D	E	B	R	I	S	T	H	A	T	E	N
	C	U	M	B	E	R	E	D	T	H	E	L	O	W	E	R	P	A	R	T	O	F	T	H	E	D	O	O	R	W	A
	Y	W	A	S	R	E	M	O	V	E	D	W	I	T	H	T	R	E	M	B	L	I	N	G	H	A	N	D	S	I	M
	A	D	E	A	T	I	N	Y	B	R	E	A	C	H	I	N	T	H	E	U	P	P	E	R	L	E	F	T	H	A	N
	D	C	O	R	N	E	R	A	N	D	T	H	E	N	W	I	D	E	N	I	N	G	T	H	E	H	O	L	E	A	L
	I	T	T	L	E	I	I	N	S	E	R	T	E	D	T	H	E	C	A	N	D	L	E	A	N	D	P	E	E	R	E
	D	I	N	T	H	E	H	O	T	A	I	R	E	S	C	A	P	I	N	G	F	R	O	M	T	H	E	C	H	A	M
	B	E	R	C	A	U	S	E	D	T	H	E	F	L	A	M	E	T	O	F	L	I	C	K	E	R	B	U	T	P	R
	E	S	E	N	T	L	Y	D	E	T	A	I	L	S	O	F	T	H	E	R	O	O	M	W	I	T	H	I	N	E	M
	E	R	G	E	D	F	R	O	M	T	H	E	M	I	S	T	X	C	A	N	Y	O	U	S	E	E	A	N	Y	T	H
	I	N	G	Q																											

The blue L on the left side is just where this extra L on the tableau side lives. Don't use it, just know where it is and how it changes a word.

This as well is something that got me stuck for quite a while. What to do, and when...

Raise the first three columns as shown. There was not K in the cypher text of K3 so Mr

		Y																												
K	R	A																												
H	E	L	P	T	O	S	B	E	T	W	E	E	N	S	U	B	T	L	E	S	H	A	D	I	N	G	A	N	D	T
I	Q	T	B	S	E	N	C	E	O	F	L	I	G	H	T	L	I	E	S	T	H	E	N	U	A	N	C	E	O	F
W	S	G	U	S	I	O	N	I	T	W	A	S	T	O	T	A	L	L	Y	I	N	V	I	S	I	B	L	E	H	O
M	A	T	H	A	T	P	O	S	S	I	B	L	E	T	H	E	Y	U	S	E	D	T	H	E	E	A	R	T	H	S
G	A	T	N	E	T	I	C	F	I	E	L	D	X	T	H	E	I	N	F	O	R	M	A	T	I	O	N	W	A	S
N	D	K	H	E	R	E	D	A	N	D	T	R	A	N	S	M	I	T	T	E	D	U	N	D	E	R	G	R	U	U
E	Y	D	O	A	N	U	N	K	N	O	W	N	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	X	D	O	E	S	L	A	N	G	L
I	E	X	N	O	W	A	B	O	U	T	T	H	I	S	T	H	E	Y	S	H	O	U	L	D	I	T	S	B	U	R
E	E	T	O	U	T	T	H	E	R	E	S	O	M	E	W	H	E	R	E	X	W	H	O	K	N	O	W	S	T	H
A	S	Y	A	C	T	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	O	N	L	Y	W	W	T	H	I	S	W	A	S	H	I	S	L
F	T	S	M	E	S	S	A	G	E	X	T	H	I	R	T	Y	E	I	G	H	T	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	F	I
N	D	I	S	E	V	E	N	M	I	N	U	T	E	S	S	I	X	P	O	I	N	T	F	I	V	E	S	E	C	O
T	M	R	N	O	R	T	H	S	E	V	E	N	T	Y	S	E	V	E	N	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	E	I	G	H
Y	E	M	N	U	T	E	S	F	O	R	T	Y	F	O	U	R	S	E	C	O	N	D	S	W	E	S	T	X	L	A
R	E	R	T	W	O	S	L	O	W	L	Y	D	E	S	P	A	R	A	T	L	Y	S	L	O	W	L	Y	T	H	E
B	E	E	A	I	N	S	O	F	P	A	S	S	A	G	E	D	E	B	R	I	S	T	H	A	T	E	N	C	U	M
S	R	I	E	D	T	H	E	L	O	W	E	R	P	A	R	T	O	F	T	H	E	D	O	O	R	W	A	Y	W	A
A	T	E	M	O	V	E	D	W	I	T	H	T	R	E	M	B	L	I	N	G	H	A	N	D	S	I	M	A	D	E
R	N	I	N	Y	B	R	E	A	C	H	I	N	T	H	E	U	P	P	E	R	L	E	F	T	H	A	N	D	C	O
L	E	E	R	A	N	D	T	H	E	N	W	I	D	E	N	I	N	G	T	H	E	H	O	L	E	A	L	I	T	T
T	H	U	I	N	S	E	R	T	E	D	T	H	E	C	A	N	D	L	E	A	N	D	P	E	E	R	E	D	I	N
C	A	L	H	O	T	A	I	R	E	S	C	A	P	I	N	G	F	R	O	M	T	H	E	C	H	A	M	B	E	R
N	T	F	S	E	D	T	H	E	F	L	A	M	E	T	O	F	L	I	C	K	E	R	B	U	T	P	R	E	S	E
E	D		Y	D	E	T	A	I	L	S	O	F	T	H	E	R	O	O	M	W	I	T	H	I	N	E	M	E	R	G
Q			R	O	M	T	H	E	M	I	S	T	X	C	A	N	Y	O	U	S	E	E	A	N	Y	T	H	I	N	G

The errors in K1-2 are highlighted just for ease. Keep track of where they are. Split what you raised a bit from the rest, as on the next page.

Count the number of characters in the first layer that needed to be discovered to decipher K4.

		Y
K	R	A

H	E	L	P
I	Q	T	B
W	S	G	U
M	A	T	H
G	A	T	N
N	D	K	H
E	Y	D	O
I	E	X	N
E	E	T	O
A	S	Y	A
F	T	S	M
N	D	I	S
T	M	R	N
Y	E	M	N
R	E	R	T
B	E	E	A
S	R	I	E
A	T	E	M
R	N	I	N
L	E	E	R
T	H	U	I
C	A	L	H
N	T	F	S
E	D		Y
Q			R

T	O	S	B	E	T	W	E	E	N	S	U	B	T	L	E	S	H	A	D	I	N	G	A	N	D	T
S	E	N	C	E	O	F	L	I	G	H	T	L	I	E	S	T	H	E	N	U	A	N	C	E	O	F
S	I	O	N	I	T	W	A	S	T	O	T	A	L	L	Y	I	N	V	I	S	I	B	L	E	H	O
A	T	P	O	S	S	I	B	L	E	T	H	E	Y	U	S	E	D	T	H	E	E	A	R	T	H	S
E	T	I	C	F	I	E	L	D	X	T	H	E	I	N	F	O	R	M	A	T	I	O	N	W	A	S
E	R	E	D	A	N	D	T	R	A	N	S	M	I	T	T	E	D	U	N	D	E	R	G	R	U	U
A	N	U	N	K	N	O	W	N	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	X	D	O	E	S	L	A	N	G	L
O	W	A	B	O	U	T	T	H	I	S	T	H	E	Y	S	H	O	U	L	D	I	T	S	B	U	R
U	T	T	H	E	R	E	S	O	M	E	W	H	E	R	E	X	W	H	O	K	N	O	W	S	T	H
C	T	L	O	C	A	T	I	O	N	O	N	L	Y	W	W	T	H	I	S	W	A	S	H	I	S	L
E	S	S	A	G	E	X	T	H	I	R	T	Y	E	I	G	H	T	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	F	I
E	V	E	N	M	I	N	U	T	E	S	S	I	X	P	O	I	N	T	F	I	V	E	S	E	C	O
O	R	T	H	S	E	V	E	N	T	Y	S	E	V	E	N	D	E	G	R	E	E	S	E	I	G	H
U	T	E	S	F	O	R	T	Y	F	O	U	R	S	E	C	O	N	D	S	W	E	S	T	X	L	A
W	O	S	L	O	W	L	Y	D	E	S	P	A	R	A	T	L	Y	S	L	O	W	L	Y	T	H	E
I	N	S	O	F	P	A	S	S	A	G	E	D	E	B	R	I	S	T	H	A	T	E	N	C	U	M
D	T	H	E	L	O	W	E	R	P	A	R	T	O	F	T	H	E	D	O	O	R	W	A	Y	W	A
O	V	E	D	W	I	T	H	T	R	E	M	B	L	I	N	G	H	A	N	D	S	I	M	A	D	E
Y	B	R	E	A	C	H	I	N	T	H	E	U	P	P	E	R	L	E	F	T	H	A	N	D	C	O
A	N	D	T	H	E	N	W	I	D	E	N	I	N	G	T	H	E	H	O	L	E	A	L	I	T	T
N	S	E	R	T	E	D	T	H	E	C	A	N	D	L	E	A	N	D	P	E	E	R	E	D	I	N
O	T	A	I	R	E	S	C	A	P	I	N	G	F	R	O	M	T	H	E	C	H	A	M	B	E	R
E	D	T	H	E	F	L	A	M	E	T	O	F	L	I	C	K	E	R	B	U	T	P	R	E	S	E
D	E	T	A	I	L	S	O	F	T	H	E	R	O	O	M	W	I	T	H	I	N	E	M	E	R	G
O	M	T	H	E	M	I	S	T	X	C	A	N	Y	O	U	S	E	E	A	N	Y	T	H	I	N	G

That's it for step 1.

Step 2 is the next layer to be discovered before you can even think of doing something to K4.